

JADE NGUYEN

(518)-645-5349

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jadenguyen.net

EXPERIENCE

Visiting Artist | Instructional Assistant Professor

Wonsook Kim School of Art, Illinois State University, Normal, IL | January 2023 – Present

- Develop university-level courses; deliver lectures and demonstrations in digital and analog photography, video art and video sculpture, and studio and on-location lighting
- Provide assistance, conceptual and technical guidance, and formative feedback; resolve student issues, questions, and concerns
- Manage darkroom, digital printing lab, and lighting studio equipment and safety
- Give artist talks, lectures, and workshops to studio arts and art history classes

Freelance Photographer

2019 – Present

- Conceptualized and captured studio and on-location images and videos of people, events, businesses, products, and landscapes for 100+ clients; editing and retouching
- Manage client-facing roles from consultation to final image delivery and invoicing

Photographer | Gallery Assistant

University Galleries, Illinois State University, Normal, IL | May 2022 – January 2026

- Digitize collection materials of 2D and 3D artworks, negatives and slides, and other delicate materials for research, exhibition, and publication using digital photography, flatbed scanners, and studio lighting; document exhibitions, lectures, and events
- Perform post-production and quality control to ensure art accuracy and fidelity; manage metadata and online photography catalogs
- Assist with exhibition installation, artwork handling, and inventory; design and distribute promotional and educational material; assist public visitors, K-12 tours, and university classes; monitor artwork and gallery safety

Photographer

DoNorth Magazine, Plattsburgh, NY | 2019 – 2021

- Photograph natural landscapes, business establishments, portraits, and private events; perform post-production to magazine's expectations and guidelines
- Collaborate with writers for on-location assignments and produce story pieces that promote tourism in the Adirondacks area

Photography Lab Technician

Art Department, SUNY Plattsburgh, Plattsburgh, NY | 2018 – 2021

- Manage darkroom, digital printing lab, and lighting studio equipment; mix and dispose darkroom chemicals according to safety measures

Graphic Design Intern

Marketing Department, SUNY Plattsburgh, Plattsburgh, NY | August – December 2019

- Design promotional and informational materials for academic departments and student organizations according to university's branding guidelines
- Develop marketing plans to promote university's goals and missions

RELATED EXPERIENCE

Judge, Life on the Illinois River Competition

Chillicothe Public Library, IL | 2025

Photographer, Ewing Manor Fundraiser

Bloomington, IL | 2024

Judge, NAACP ACT-SO

Bloomington-Normal, IL | 2023

EDUCATION

Illinois State University

Master of Fine Arts | 2024

Photography

State University of New York at Plattsburgh

Bachelor of Fine Arts | 2021

Photography and Graphic Design

Minor in Web Design and Programming

SKILLS

Digital photography

Darkroom photography

Experimental photography

Studio lighting

Digital imaging

Graphic design

Video capture & editing

HTML & CSS

Gallery documentation

Archive digitization

Exhibition planning

Classroom management

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SELECTED EXHIBITIONS

Otherism

Puffin Cultural Forum, Teaneck, NJ | 2026

Diptych

Praxis Gallery, St. Paul, MN | 2026

Emerging Artist Exhibition

McLean County Arts Center, Bloomington, IL | 2026

Midwest Regional

Artlink, Fort Wayne, IN | 2026

Visual Narratives: 27th Juried Exhibition

Photographic Center Northwest, Seattle, WA | 2025

Things We Carry: an Asian Experience

Studio Montclair, Montclair, NJ | 2025

A Conversation Between

University Galleries, Normal, IL | 2025

agora, solo exhibition

St. Louis Artist Guild, St. Louis, MO | 2025

Photo Triennial

Galesburg Community Art Center, Galesburg, IL | 2025

Photography Now

Woman Made Gallery, Chicago, IL | 2025

This House is Not For Sale, solo exhibition

McLean County Arts Center, Bloomington, IL | 2025

polyphony, MFA Thesis Exhibition

University Galleries, Illinois State University, Normal, IL | 2024

McLean County Art Exhibition

McLean County Arts Center, Bloomington, IL | 2024

mutualism, two-person exhibition

Juillian Hall Gallery, Illinois State University, Normal, IL | 2023

in our place

Midwest Nice Art, Aberdeen, SD | 2023

returning to, two-person exhibition

Central Illinois Regional Airport Gallery, Bloomington, IL | 2022

14,000km, solo exhibition

Rachel Cooper Gallery, Illinois State University, Normal, IL | 2022

McLean County Art Exhibition

McLean County Arts Center, Bloomington, IL | 2021

ARTIST TALKS AND LECTURES

2D Fundamentals, Illinois State University | 2026

World Art, Illinois State University | 2023

Race and Visual Rhetoric, Illinois State University | 2023

Art Career Practices, Illinois State University | 2023

PUBLICATIONS

Aeonian Magazine, interview, Issue 14 | 2026

Attention Is Discovery: The Life and Legacy of Astronomer Henrietta Leavitt, Anna Von Mertens | 2025

F-Stop Magazine, Issue 130: Inhabit | 2025

Lenscratch Magazine, Interview with Brian Ulrich | 2024

Opt West Magazine, Issue 3 | 2023

Spoon River Poetry Review, Issue 48.1, | 2023

Luna Collective Magazine | 2023

Opt West Magazine, Issue 2 | 2023

Analog Forever Zine, Street Scenes/Streets, Seen | 2023

Hyperallergic, Nazafarin Lotfi: Dreams Up a Borderless Future | 2023

DoNorth Magazine, Summer 2019 – Spring 2021

AWARDS

Things We Carry, Best in Show, Studio Montclair | 2025

Photo Triennial, Runner-up, Galesburg Art Center | 2025

McLean County Art Exhibition, Best in Show,
McLean County Arts Center, Bloomington, IL | 2024

Lenscratch Student Prize, Top 26, Lenscratch | 2023

Robert Small Writing Award, Illinois State University | 2023

Karen Deske Scholarship, Illinois State University | 2023

Karolee Johnson Memorial Award, Student Annual
exhibition, Illinois State University | 2023

Image of Research, Runner-up, Illinois State University | 2022

Barbara J. Parnass Scholarship in Photography,
SUNY Plattsburgh | 2021

Winkle Scholarship of the Art, SUNY Plattsburgh | 2018 – 2020

DEMONSTRATIONS AND WORKSHOPS

Video Sculpture, Sculpture 1

Illinois State University | 2026

Gallery Documentation, University Galleries

Illinois State University | 2025